



▲ FORSYTH PATENT PERCUSSION SPORTING GUN

Date c.1808

Origin England

Barrel 32½in (82.2cm)

Caliber .73in (18.5mm)

This sporting gun was fired using Forsyth's "scent-bottle" lock. Loose fulminate powder (the chemical primer) was contained in a rotating magazine. This was fitted with a striker. To fire the gun, a user pulled the hammer back and then rotated the vessel backward, which deposited some fulminate in a small hole in the axle. Pulling the trigger released the hammer, which hit the striker in the vessel, detonating the primer.



▲ ENGLISH PELLET-LOCK PERCUSSION GUN

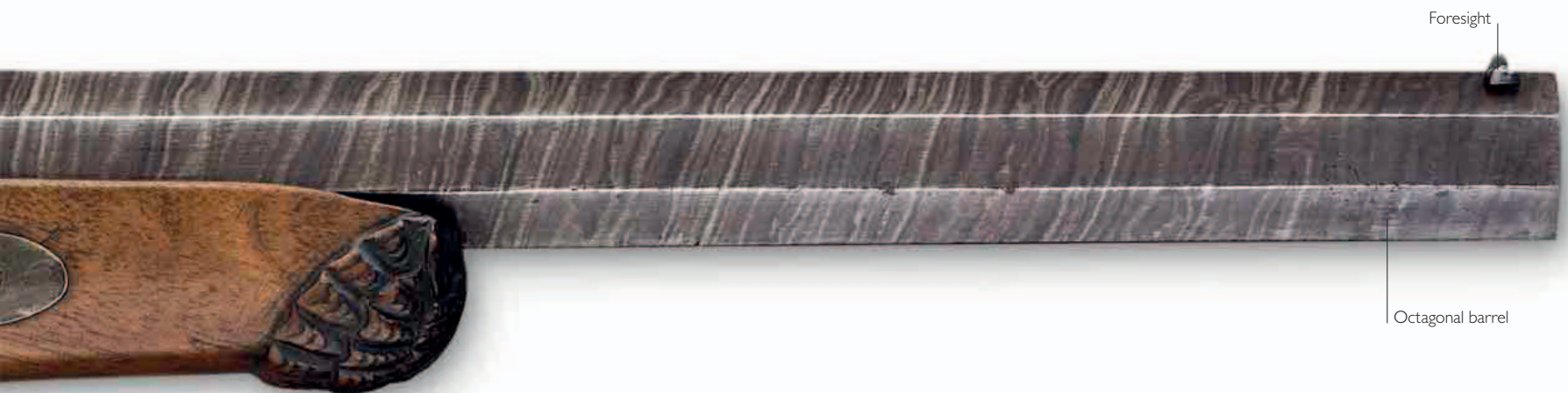
Date 1820

Origin England

Barrel 32½in (82.2cm)

Caliber .73in (18.5mm)

This gun utilized a "pellet-lock" system, which was a major early step in the evolution of percussion (chemical ignition) technology. The detonating material in this gun was bound with gum or varnish, and the pellets thus formed were contained in a rotating drum attached to the cock. Each partial rotation of the drum brought a fresh, unfired pellet over the nipple, onto which the pellet was driven by the hammer.



▲ NOCK VOLLEY GUN

Date 1795, converted to percussion in c.1830

Origin England

Barrel 20½in (52cm)

Caliber .39in (9.9mm)

A version of this seven-barreled gun was used by the British Royal Navy in close-range fighting when boarding a ship or attempting to repel enemy boarders. This gun, like many flintlock weapons, was modernized by being converted to percussion ignition. Its central barrel was fired by the percussion cap. The exploding charge of the gunpowder in its breech was linked by radiating vents to those of the other six barrels, which fired simultaneously as a volley.